

COMPARATIVE CHART SHOWS:

In March 2003, the power supply of the state was 2990 MW.

Between January 1999 and December 2003, Rs 344 crore power was purchased.

At present, it has grown to 5732 MW which is 2742 MW more than the preceding year.

In the last three years, power worth Rs 2000 crore was purchased.

In a short span of time itself the transmission capacity increased by 2000 MVA as a result of laying up of 3746 circuit k.m. high tension lines and 52 new high tension power sub station. Moreover transmission faults in the year 2002-03 were 7.93 percent which decreased up to 5 percent.

Due to this expansion in the field of production, transmission and distribution of about 10.31 hours (at three phase) of power supply was provided to agriculture consumers. Whereas in the year 2002-03 it was only for 6 hours.



As per the figures from January 1999 to December 2003 about 1576.98 million units of power (worth Rs. 344.38 crore) were purchased against which from January 2004 to July 2007, 5823.10 million units (worth Rs. 2056.98) was relieved to the consumers.

All due to concerted efforts by the present government, it is a clean growth of 92 percent on the installed capacity of 2003.

Very soon another 400 MW would be added to the capacity. Transmission capacity has also gone up by 44%.

BACKING-UP FARMERS

At the recently held Kisan Panchayat, Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan introduced a new scheme "Krishak Vidyut Rahat Yojana". Fifty percent of energy surcharge on the pending bills of agriculture pumps consumers would be borne by power distribution companies. Farmers would be given the facility of advance payment of bills of six months twice a year. Consumers of agriculture pumps up to 500 units (5 H.P.) would have to pay at the rate of 75 paise per unit from April 2008. Presently, this tariff is to the tune of Rs 1.20 per unit for 3 H.P. pump up to three hundred units and Rs 1.70 per unit on units consumed above that limit. Consumers of all the categories would get relief of 40 to 50 percent in payment of power bills in the wake of slashing of tariffs. Power would be supplied from separate feeders to agriculture irrigation pumps and domestic consumers in the rural areas.



The government of Madhya Pradesh is much concerned about the interest and welfare of the rural masses, especially farmers. On the due bills related to power connection of flour mills in rural areas, the state government has waived the surcharge and arranged for payments in installments. A special scheme named 'Suvidha' has also been initiated to provide relief to the farmers who have a huge amount to be paid for their power bills. Under the scheme, the surcharge amount has been reduced by 70 to 80 per cent on the due bills. The farmers can make payment in eight easy monthly installments.

Another scheme named 'Sona-Chandi' has also been in place since last year, with a view to simplify the process of providing temporary pump connections. Under this scheme, the farmers going for water-pump connections are provided electricity surcharge that is relaxed for one month. This is in an attempt to motivate farmers to take pump connections for a longer period, than just a month.

Before you think that MPSEB and the Electricity Distribution Company (EDC) are bearing the brunt of the state government's relief scheme to the farmers, pause for a moment. The government has paid the entire amount of the waived electricity bills to the tune of Rs 1,783 crore during the last three years.

In the larger interest of the farmers, the state government also resurrected the state electricity board which was ailing under the dues equalling an amount of Rs 2,523.65 crore to be paid to the Rural Electrification Corporation (REC) till March 31, 2004. The state government formulated a tri-partite agreement under which it paid Rs 1,414.80 crore to REC and waived off the interest of Rs 744 crore on the state electricity board. Not only this, the government also helped the board in availing the grant from REC.

POTENTIAL INHERENT

En route for making Madhya Pradesh power surplus in the next few years, the state government has entered into a joint venture with the National Hydro-electric Power Corporation for executing power vigouring projects — hydro-electric power projects of 1,000 MW and 520 MW at Indira Sagar and Omkareshwar, respectively. At Khandwa, the state government is coming up with 1,000 MW capacity of thermal power plant. Additionally, the state also possesses eight hydro-electric power stations with 747.5 MW of installed capacity. The Maheshwar Hydro-electric Project is soon going to be operational.

As a result of this dedication towards boosting power, the Shivraj Singh Chouhan government achieved 2,611 MW of installed capacity of thermal power in the last four years, a phenomenal performance when compared to previous 2,990 MW of installed capacity achieved in 47 years.

The Chouhan government is making optimum use of the low-grade coal, which is present in the state in abundance and is appropriate for power generation. The state also has an immense potential to generate hydro energy. Investors like Essar Power, Jaypee Power, ISN International, and many others have shown their interest in investing in the emerging power sector of the state. 18 Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) amounting to Rs 39,000 were signed in the International Investors' Meet, held at Khajuraho in January this year.

Thanks to the Shivraj Singh Chouhan government of which is taking giant strides towards attaining self-reliance and simultaneously putting up an efficient power system in place in the state. The state government's dream, of building a POWER-full state, will soon turn into reality indeed.